I Do We Do You Do

Moving towards independence

Use I Do, We Do, You Do to move students from observing a clear model to accurate independence. The phases may repeat; readiness determines the handover.

How to do it well

1 I Do the model. Explain one coherent example, revealing the method and the reasons for key choices.

2 We Do a related example. Students supply a decision or step while the teacher guides, checks and corrects.

3 Check the whole class. Use boards, a brief written response or a practical demonstration rather than assuming readiness from volunteers.

4 You Do a small attempt. Give a closely matched task that students complete independently, with success criteria and any necessary temporary support.

5 Increase responsibility. Remove prompts and add variation when performance is sufficiently secure; return to guidance if common errors persist.

What this sounds like

“Watch my example first. You will now try a different example one step at a time. Once those decisions are secure, you will complete the next one independently.”

Classroom example. A teacher models one paragraph, guides a second response using different evidence and collects everyone’s opening claim. Where the claim is secure, pupils attempt another paragraph independently. A common gap in the explanation leads to a short return to modelling. The phases repeat according to readiness rather than a fixed allocation of minutes.

Top tips that make the technique work

Use different examples. We Do should require the same underlying learning without being a copy of the I Do.

Keep the model visible initially. Support comparison without allowing students simply to substitute a superficial detail.

Make We Do genuinely participatory. Every student attempts a step; a few pupils supplying answers is not class-wide rehearsal.

Release a short first task. Inspect early independent work before students repeat the method across many items.

Loop back when needed. Re-model a sticking point rather than persisting with independent work students cannot yet complete.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use evidence to decide the release.	Treating phases as fixed time slots.
Preserve the connection between model and practice.	Making You Do substantially harder without teaching the new demand.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

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